

THE QUESTION

One page. One question. Nothing competes with it.



Does the Army's promotion and career-development continuum deliberately prepare, select and develop its people for the changes in leadership purpose, mindset, behaviours, scope and scale required at each LDF transition?

AITC discussion piece · NZALC · DRAFT

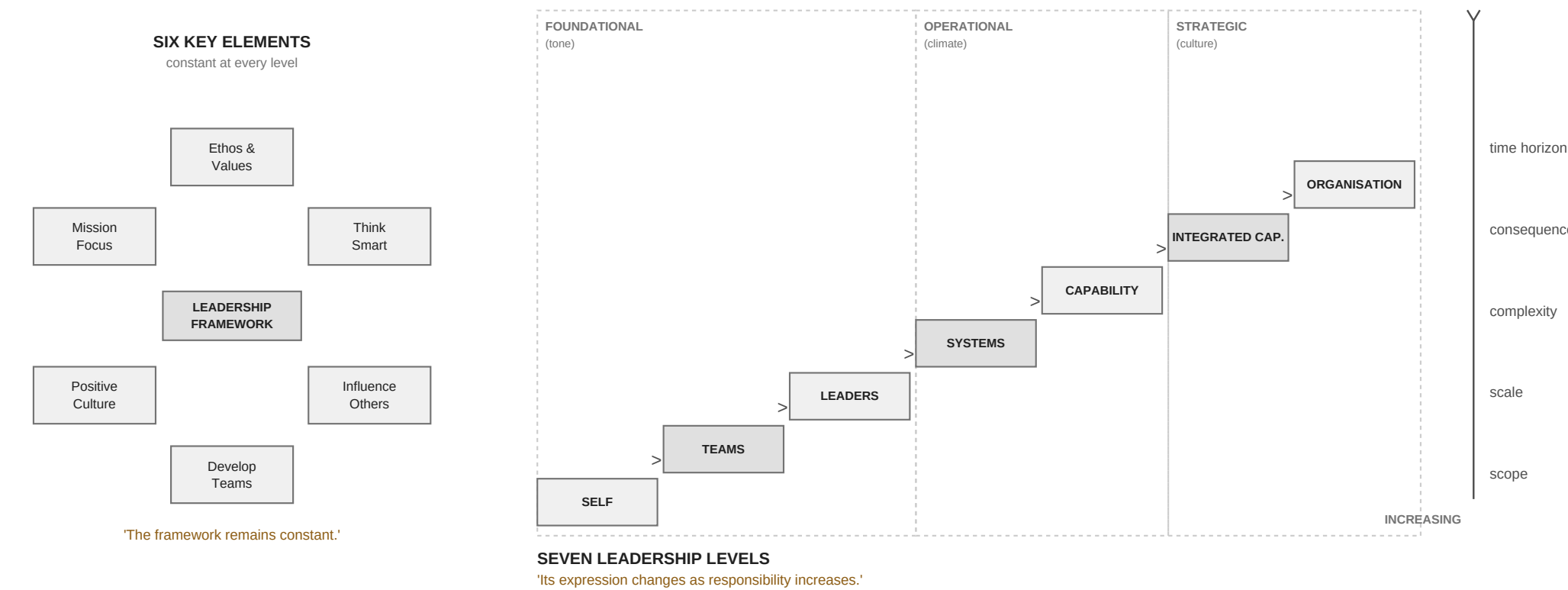
[No subtitle. No agenda. No sources. Those come on page 2.]

VISUAL LOGIC

The reader should be able to repeat the question from memory after this page. Type only, generous white space, one weight. The word 'deliberately' may be set heavier than the rest in the polished version; it is the hinge of the analysis.

THE SYSTEM WE ALREADY HAVE

Six constant elements + seven progressive levels + increasing scope. Source material simplified into one picture.

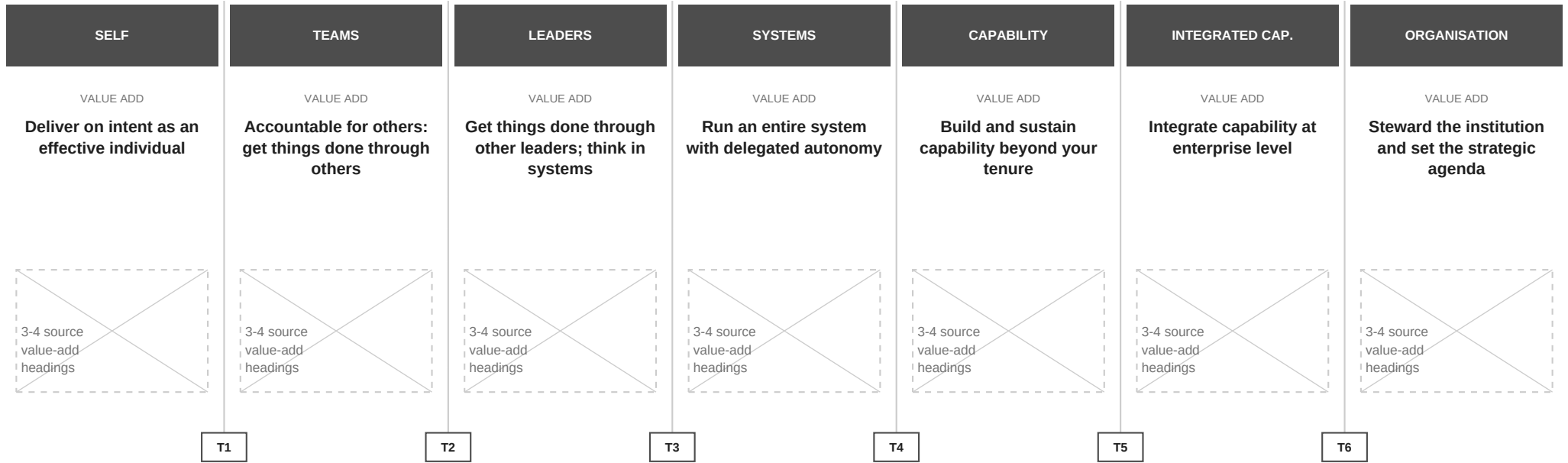


THE FRAMEWORK REMAINS CONSTANT. ITS EXPRESSION CHANGES AS LEADERSHIP RESPONSIBILITY INCREASES.

VISUAL LOGIC
Three source posters become one picture: the ring (what), the staircase (progression), the axis (why the progression is hard). The three LDF environments are shown as faint bands so the reader sees that Foundational, Operational and Strategic are where mindset changes cluster. No behaviour statements appear here; they live in the source document, not the brief.

WHAT ACTUALLY CHANGES?

Seven levels, one line each. Promotion into greater responsibility is a developmental transition, not a change of rank.



T1 to T6 are the six transitions. From page 4 onward the TRANSITION, not the level, is the row.

WHAT THE LDF SAYS SHIFTS AT EACH STEP (from the Value Adds and level introductions)

intent & mastery	through others	through leaders; systems thinking	run the system; succession	beyond tenure; advise upward	enterprise; external partners	stewardship; ministerial trust
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VISUAL LOGIC

Each column carries one bold sentence, verified against the level's Value Adds. The dashed placeholders hold the three or four Value Add headings from the source so the sentence is traceable, not invented. The T1 to T6 gates are introduced here and reused on every following page.

TWO CAREER SYSTEMS. ONE LEADERSHIP FRAMEWORK.

The centrepiece. Officer left, Other Rank right, the LDF spine fixed in the middle. Rows are transitions, not levels.

OFFICER CONTINUUM						NZDF LDF TRANSITIONS	OTHER RANK CONTINUUM					
Assurance	Timing	Career linkage	Formal development	Appointment / responsibility	Rank / career point		Rank / career point	Appointment / responsibility	Formal development	Career linkage	Timing	Assurance
.	.	.	embedded in single-Service courses (LDS)	.	OCDT > JO (LDS estimate)	T1 SELF > TEAMS WHAT CHANGES: Accountable for others: get things done through others	PTE > LCPL/CPL (LDS estimate)	.	embedded in single-Service courses (LDS)	.	.	.
DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM		TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED
.	.	.	single-Service provider (LDS)	.	JO (LDS estimate)	T2 TEAMS > LEADERS WHAT CHANGES: Get things done through other leaders; think in systems	SGT/SSGT (LDS estimate)	.	single-Service provider (LDS)	.	.	.
DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM		TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED
.	.	.	ILD delivers LDS course	.	MAJ (LDS estimate)	T3 LEADERS > SYSTEMS WHAT CHANGES: Run an entire system with delegated autonomy	WO (LDS estimate)	.	ILD delivers LDS course	.	.	.
DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM		TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED
.	.	.	ILD delivers LDS course	.	LTCOL (LDS estimate)	T4 SYSTEMS > CAPABILITY WHAT CHANGES: Build and sustain capability beyond your tenure	Tier 5 WO (LDS estimate)	.	ILD delivers LDS course	.	.	.
DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM		TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED
.	.	.	ILD delivers LDS course	.	COL (LDS estimate)	T5 CAPABILITY > INTEGRATED CAP. WHAT CHANGES: Integrate capability at enterprise level	Tier 4 WO (LDS estimate)	.	ILD delivers LDS course	.	.	.
DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM		TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED
.	.	.	ILD delivers LDS course	.	BRIG+ (LDS estimate)	T6 INTEGRATED CAP. > ORGANISATION WHAT CHANGES: Steward the institution and set the strategic agenda	Tier 3 WO+ (LDS estimate)	.	ILD delivers LDS course	.	.	.
DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM		TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	TO CONFIRM	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED	DATA REQUIRED

Status chips: KNOWN (from source) · TO CONFIRM (source is an estimate or a session document) · DATA REQUIRED (nothing in hand). Colour comes later; the chip text is the primary signal.

VISUAL LOGIC

Reading order is deliberate: the eye lands on the dark spine, reads a transition and 'what changes', then looks left (officer) and right (OR) to test whether each system prepares for that change. Officer columns run right-to-left so the two sides mirror around the spine and the same category sits at the same distance from it. Populated cells here are limited to what the four sources state: the LDS course delivery model per level and the rank-to-level estimate from the Leadership Levels poster (itself marked 'only an estimation'). Everything else is a grey DATA REQUIRED chip.

WHERE DO THE SYSTEMS ALIGN?

Same matrix. Only demonstrable connections stay solid; everything else recedes.

OFFICER CONTINUUM						NZDF LDF TRANSITIONS	OTHER RANK CONTINUUM					
Assurance	Timing	Career linkage	Formal development	Appointment / responsibility	Rank / career point		Rank / career point	Appointment / responsibility	Formal development	Career linkage	Timing	Assurance
.	.	.	ALIGNED?	.	.	T1 SELF > TEAMS WHAT CHANGES: Accountable for others: get things done through others	.	.	ALIGNED?	.	.	.
.	.	.	ALIGNED?	.	.	T2 TEAMS > LEADERS WHAT CHANGES: Get things done through other leaders; think in systems	.	.	ALIGNED?	.	.	.
.	.	.	.	.	.	T3 LEADERS > SYSTEMS WHAT CHANGES: Run an entire system with delegated autonomy	.	.	.	.	.	.
.	.	.	.	.	.	T4 SYSTEMS > CAPABILITY WHAT CHANGES: Build and sustain capability beyond your tenure	.	.	.	.	.	.
.	.	.	.	.	.	T5 CAPABILITY > INTEGRATED CAP. WHAT CHANGES: Integrate capability at enterprise level	.	.	.	.	.	.
.	.	.	.	.	.	T6 INTEGRATED CAP. > ORGANISATION WHAT CHANGES: Steward the institution and set the strategic agenda	.	.	.	.	.	.

Solid cell = evidence in hand that development, career point and consequence connect. Faded cell = not shown on this page, not 'no'.

VISUAL LOGIC

This page is the positive case. It uses the identical grid so the reader is not re-orienting, and simply removes what is not aligned. In the polished version aligned cells are green and linked to the spine with a short connector; nothing else is coloured. The two cells shown solid are illustrative of the treatment only; which cells qualify is decided by the data, not by this wireframe.

WHERE ARE THE GAPS?

Same matrix. Each gap is named by type, so the reader sees the nature of the problem, not just a red cell.

OFFICER CONTINUUM						NZDF LDF TRANSITIONS	OTHER RANK CONTINUUM					
Assurance	Timing	Career linkage	Formal development	Appointment / responsibility	Rank / career point		Rank / career point	Appointment / responsibility	Formal development	Career linkage	Timing	Assurance
						T1SELF > TEAMS WHAT CHANGES: Accountable for others: get things done through others						
DATA	ASSURANCE	CONSEQUENCE	DATA	DATA	DATA		DATA	DATA	DATA	CONSEQUENCE	ASSURANCE	DATA
						T2TEAMS > LEADERS WHAT CHANGES: Get things done through other leaders; think in systems						
DEVELOPMENT	DATA	ASSURANCE	DATA	DATA	DATA		DATA	DATA	DATA	ASSURANCE	DATA	DEVELOPMENT
						T3LEADERS > SYSTEMS WHAT CHANGES: Run an entire system with delegated autonomy						
ALIGNMENT	DEVELOPMENT	DATA	DATA	DATA	DATA		DATA	DATA	DATA	DATA	DEVELOPMENT	ALIGNMENT
						T4SYSTEMS > CAPABILITY WHAT CHANGES: Build and sustain capability beyond your tenure						
TIMING	ALIGNMENT	DEVELOPMENT	DATA	DATA	DATA		DATA	DATA	DATA	DEVELOPMENT	ALIGNMENT	TIMING
						T5CAPABILITY > INTEGRATED CAP. WHAT CHANGES: Integrate capability at enterprise level						
CONSEQUENCE	TIMING	ALIGNMENT	DATA	DATA	DATA		DATA	DATA	DATA	ALIGNMENT	TIMING	CONSEQUENCE
						T6INTEGRATED CAP. > ORGANISATION WHAT CHANGES: Steward the institution and set the strategic agenda						
ASSURANCE	CONSEQUENCE	TIMING	DATA	DATA	DATA		DATA	DATA	DATA	TIMING	CONSEQUENCE	ASSURANCE

GAP TAXONOMY

- DEVELOPMENT

no deliberate development for the transition
- ALIGNMENT

development exists but does not match the LDF shift
- TIMING

development occurs after the transition
- CONSEQUENCE

development has no formal link to promotion or appointment
- ASSURANCE

no mechanism establishes readiness
- DATA

insufficient information

VISUAL LOGIC

Tags shown here are placeholders to test density, not findings. Amber and red are reserved for this page and page 5; the tag text carries the meaning so the page still works in greyscale. Officer-versus-OR asymmetries are read across a row: the same transition, two different answers. Where evidence is thin the tag is DATA, never a judgement.

THE QUESTION FOR ARMY

End at the strategic level. No answer is predetermined.

If the LDF defines the leadership transitions Army expects its people to make, how deliberately should promotion, appointment and professional development be aligned to those transitions?

PROMOTION

[the three levers AITC controls; no recommendation attached]

APPOINTMENT

[the three levers AITC controls; no recommendation attached]

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

[the three levers AITC controls; no recommendation attached]

VISUAL LOGIC

Mirror of page 1: type only, one question. The three levers are named because they are the decision space, but no option, model or preferred answer is shown. The page exists to hand the discussion to AITC, not to close it.